

2.2 Open source for media authoring

2.2.1 Audio editing

Traverso (<http://traverso-daw.org/>)

This is a very capable open source multi track audio editor and recording application, available for Windows, Linux and Mac users. The interface is a slightly complicated when compared to Audacity. However, on giving a closer look at it, you would realise its power. Overall, Traverso is regarded by many as an alternative to more popular commercial applications such as Sony Acid Pro and Adobe Audition.

We used Traverso on Linux. The UI is quite easy to master, with shortcut keys for all functions related to editing and mastering, and a comprehensive online help file. Traverso has also included an CD writing module, so there is no need for an external burning application to create audio CDs of the edited tracks.

Audacity (<http://audacity.sourceforge.net/>) is another open source audio editor that has an impressive gamut of functionalities as Traverso, but since it is popular and has been reviewed many times before, just a cursory mention should suffice.

Additional resources

Rosegarden (www.rosegardenmusic.com) and Ardour (www.ardour.org) are two open source audio editing tools that are not available under Windows. A long list of more audio applications is available at www.opensound.com/ossapps.html

2.2.2 Video editing

Avidemux (<http://avidemux.sourceforge.net/>)

If you've used VirtualDub (a popular open source video editing application especially for AVI files), then you'll feel right at home with Avidemux. Providing most of the functionalities of the former, Avidemux ups the ante by also allowing editing and encoding several more file types, including FLV (flash video popularly used in YouTube and other online video platforms) format.

Again, we tested Avidemux under Linux. Its capabilities range from simple video editing – cutting scenes is as simple marking them and using [Ctrl] + [X] (when we tried